Japan equity theme watch map

MARKET THEME MAP / 2026.09 | Observe fund flows through whole-theme price movements as well as individual stocks

Seven major themes (1-4)

01 AI and semiconductors
Check how widely price moves spread across equipment, materials and chipmakers.
Tokyo Electron / Advantest / DISCO / KOKUSAI ELECTRIC / Shin-Etsu Chemical / SUMCO / Kioxia Holdings / Renesas / ROHM / SoftBank Group.

02 Data centers and power
Watch demand for communications, power transmission and distribution, electrical equipment and cooling against AI computing demand.
Fujikura / Furukawa Electric / Sumitomo Electric Industries; power equipment, cooling and data-center-related businesses.

03 Rising interest rates
Compare bank, insurance and other financial share movements with long-term interest rates.
Banks / regional banks / insurance / long-term interest rates.

04 Rare earths and resources
Focus on supply constraints, geopolitics and resource prices. Check links with EVs, semiconductors and defense.
Rare earths / copper / nonferrous metals / resource development.

Compiled as of September 16, 2026.

Japan equity theme watch map

MARKET THEME MAP / 2026.09 | Seven major themes (5-7) and interpretation

05 Oil and gas
Watch crude oil and LNG prices, geopolitics and changes in inflation expectations.
Resource development / petroleum refiners and wholesalers / LNG-related businesses.

06 Defense and space
Watch defense budgets and space development, along with policy and order expectations.
Heavy industry / defense electronics / satellites / space / drones.

07 Foreign exchange
Yen appreciation and depreciation are common factors affecting multiple themes.
Stronger yen: watch domestic-demand and import-oriented companies.
Weaker yen: watch exporters and companies with high overseas sales shares.

Semiconductors: breadth of gains and related sectors
Distinguish between gains across equipment, materials and chipmakers and gains confined to a few large stocks. Check finished-product manufacturers (Nintendo, Sony Group, Yamaha, Daikin, Sharp, Honda, Canon and Ricoh) as comparisons, but they do not always move opposite to semiconductor shares.

Gauges of theme strength
Strong: most constituents rise and move in the same direction.
Weak: broad declines among constituents. Compare with other themes too.
Sequence: check the theme's overall momentum before individual stocks.

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